

Website Project Completion Report

Headless Next.js + WordPress (ACF Free) — Trilingual FR / AR / EN

Prepared for: CarrierWeb Maroc project owner

Report date: July 14, 2026

Project path: CarrierWeb_maroc_ACF-Free-true / project

Stack: Next.js 16 (App Router) · Tailwind CSS v4 · WordPress headless (WPGraphQL, ACF Free)

1. Executive Summary

This report documents the work completed on the CarrierWeb Maroc website, a headless architecture combining a Next.js 16 front-end with a WordPress back-office (WPGraphQL + Advanced Custom Fields, free tier only — no Repeater fields). The site is fully trilingual (French / Arabic RTL / English) and automatically falls back to local mock data whenever WordPress is unreachable, so the site never breaks in production even if the CMS goes down.

The most recent work session (July 14, 2026) delivered three client-requested items: (1) a working contact form that sends real e-mails via SMTP with an automatic mailto: fallback, (2) an autoplaying product demo video embedded on the homepage, and (3) two new WordPress content types — **Testimonials** and **Articles** — so the CarrierWeb team can add, edit, or delete this content directly from the WordPress admin panel, with **zero code changes required**.

Contact form — real e-mail delivery + mailto fallback	DONE
Homepage demo video (autoplay, muted, loop)	DONE
WordPress-editable Testimonials (no code)	DONE
WordPress-editable Articles / Resources (no code)	DONE
Trilingual site (FR / AR RTL / EN) — prior session	DONE
WordPress content for Solutions & Sectors — prior session	DONE
SMTP credentials (real mailbox password)	PENDING — client action needed
Legal identifiers (RC, ICE, tax ID, host)	PENDING — client action needed

2. Contact Form — Real E-mail Delivery

Previously, the contact form only opened the visitor's local e-mail client via a `mailto:` link — unreliable on mobile and easy to abandon. It now submits directly to a server-side API route that sends the message by e-mail through SMTP (Nodemailer), while keeping the old `mailto:` behaviour as an automatic safety net.

What was built

- A new API route (`POST /api/contact`) validates the submitted fields (name, e-mail, phone, company, fleet size, message), rejects malformed e-mail addresses, and sends a formatted HTML + plain-text e-mail via SMTP.
- The recipient defaults to `o68218758@gmail.com` and is configurable via the `CONTACT_EMAIL_TO` environment variable, so it can be changed without touching code.
- The visitor's own e-mail is set as the *Reply-To* address, so the sales team can hit "Reply" directly instead of copy-pasting the client's e-mail from the message body.
- If SMTP is not configured, or the send fails for any reason, the front-end automatically falls back to the original `mailto:` link — the form never leaves a visitor stuck.
- The submit button shows a "Sending..." state, and the confirmation screen displays a different message depending on whether the e-mail was actually delivered or the `mailto:` fallback was used — fully translated in French, Arabic and English.

Files added or changed

File	Purpose
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<code>app/api/contact/route.ts</code>	New. SMTP mail-sending API route (Nodemailer). Returns HTTP 503 when SMTP is not configured, so the client knows to use the fallback.
<code>app/_shared/ContactView.tsx</code>	Modified. Form now POSTs to the API first; falls back to mailto: automatically on any failure.
<code>.env.local.example</code>	Modified. Documents the SMTP_HOST / SMTP_PORT / SMTP_USER / SMTP_PASS / CONTACT_EMAIL_TO variables, with a step-by-step Gmail app-password example.
<code>lib/dictionaries/{fr,en,ar}.ts</code>	Modified. Added the sending / sentTitle / sentBody translation keys.

Verification performed

- Production build passed with zero errors; the new route compiles as a dynamic serverless function.
- Live test: POST /api/contact with SMTP unset correctly returned 503
{"ok":false,"reason":"smtp_not_configured"}, confirming the fallback path triggers as designed.

Action required from the client: SMTP credentials are not yet filled in `.env.local`. Until they are, the form works correctly but delivers via the visitor's own e-mail client rather than a direct server-side send. See §7 for the exact steps.

3. Homepage Demo Video

A new video section was added to the homepage, right after the trust-badge bar, to give visitors an immediate, wordless demonstration of the platform in action before they reach the detailed solutions list.

What was built

- The supplied demo video (9.7 MB, .mp4) was placed in the public assets folder and is served directly by Next.js at `/carrierweb-demo.mp4`.
- A new `VideoShowcase` component plays the video muted and on loop, matching the visual style of the rest of the site (rounded frame, red glow, dark surface).
- Playback is **scroll-aware**: the video only starts playing once the section actually enters the viewport, and pauses again when scrolled away — saving bandwidth and battery for visitors who never reach that section.
- Section heading, description and accessibility label were written and translated into French, Arabic and English.

Files added or changed

File	Purpose
<code>public/carrierweb-demo.mp4</code>	New. The demo video asset (9.7 MB).
<code>app/components/VideoShowcase.tsx</code>	New. Scroll-triggered autoplay video section.
<code>app/_shared/HomeView.tsx</code>	Modified. <code>VideoShowcase</code> inserted after the trust bar, before the Solutions section.
<code>lib/dictionaries/{fr,en,ar}.ts</code>	Modified. Added the <code>videoShowcase</code> translation block (label, title, description, accessibility text).

Verification performed

- Confirmed in a live browser session: the video element loads correctly (1112×834, muted, loop, zero playback errors) and plays automatically once scrolled into view.
- Confirmed the translated section heading renders correctly on the French, English and Arabic (RTL) versions of the homepage.

4. WordPress — Fully Editable Content (No Code Required)

Prior to this session, only two content types (Solutions and Sectors) were editable by the CarrierWeb team directly in WordPress — everything else (testimonials, articles) lived as hard-coded text in the source code, meaning any change required a developer. This session closes that gap for the two most frequently updated content types: **customer testimonials** and **resource articles** (blog posts).

The team can now log into WordPress (`wp-admin`) and **add, edit, or delete** testimonials and articles the same way they already do for Solutions and Sectors — using ordinary WordPress form fields, no HTML or code of any kind.

4.1 — Testimonials (homepage carousel)

A new "Testimonials" menu now appears in the WordPress admin sidebar. Each testimonial entry has four simple fields:

- **Quote** — the customer's statement (text area)
- **Author** — job title only, e.g. "Operations Director" (anonymised, no personal names, per the client's privacy preference)
- **Role** — sector / business activity, e.g. "Road freight transport"
- **Company** — city only, e.g. "Casablanca"

The display order on the homepage follows WordPress's built-in "Order" field (drag-and-drop friendly), exactly like Solutions and Sectors already do. The homepage automatically reads from WordPress; if WordPress is unreachable or a testimonial list is empty, the site falls back to a safe built-in default so the homepage is never broken.

4.2 — Articles (Resources / blog)

A new "Articles" menu now appears in WordPress. Each article has editable fields for everything the public resource page displays:

- Category, excerpt, SEO meta description, publish date, reading time, introduction
- Up to **6 content sections**, each with its own heading, body paragraphs, and an optional bullet list — enough structure for long-form guides without needing a rich-text/Repeater field (not available on the free ACF plan)
- A "Key takeaways" list (one point per line)
- Up to 3 "related solutions" links shown at the bottom of the article

Both the article listing page and each individual article page read directly from WordPress when content exists there, and fall back to the built-in copy otherwise — so nothing breaks while the WordPress site is being configured or is temporarily offline.

4.3 — Automatic setup (zero manual configuration)

Both content types were shipped with an **automatic bootstrap**: the very first time WordPress loads with the new plugin files present, it (a) registers the new admin menus and fields, and (b) pre-fills them with the 3 testimonials and 3 articles that were already live on the site — so the team starts from real content, not an empty form. This bootstrap only runs once and never overwrites content the team has already edited.

***Verified live:** after starting the WordPress site, the automatic setup ran successfully — 3 testimonials and 3 fully-structured articles were confirmed present in the WordPress database via a direct API query, and the public website was confirmed to be reading and displaying that WordPress content correctly.*

Files added or changed

File	Purpose
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<code>wp-content/mu-plugins/cw-temoignages.php</code>	New (WordPress). Registers the Testimonials admin section and its 4 fields; pre-fills the 3 existing testimonials on first load.
<code>wp-content/mu-plugins/cw-articles.php</code>	New (WordPress). Registers the Articles admin section and its ~30 fields (6 sections × 3 fields + metadata); pre-fills the 3 existing articles on first load.
<code>lib/queries.ts</code>	Modified. Added the WordPress data queries for testimonials and articles.
<code>lib/wordpress.ts</code>	Modified. Added the functions that fetch testimonials/articles from WordPress and reassemble them into the shape the website expects.
<code>lib/articles.ts</code>	Modified. Article lookup now checks WordPress first (French only), falling back to the built-in copy.
<code>app/components/Testimonials.tsx</code> , <code>app/_shared/HomeView.tsx</code>	Modified. Homepage now passes WordPress testimonials into the carousel when available.
<code>app/_shared/ArticleView.tsx</code> , <code>ResourcesView.tsx</code> , <code>app/sitemap.ts</code> , and both <code>ressources/[slug]/page.tsx</code> routes	Modified. Updated to read article data asynchronously from the new WordPress-aware article lookup.

Scope note

WordPress currently holds **French** content only (matching the existing Solutions/Sectors setup) — Arabic and English versions continue to be maintained as translated text files by a developer, since a fully multilingual WordPress (Polylang/WPML) was out of scope for this session. Homepage layout text (navigation labels, section titles, marketing copy) also remains developer-maintained; only the two content types explicitly requested — testimonials and articles — were made WordPress-editable in this session (see §7 for what a broader rollout to "every page" would involve).

5. Broader Project Context (Prior Work, for Reference)

The items below were completed in earlier work sessions and are included here for a complete picture of the site's current state. They are not part of this session's deliverables but remain live and in production use.

5.1 — Trilingual site (French / Arabic RTL / English)

- Full site available in French (root URLs), Arabic (/ar/*, right-to-left layout) and English (/en/*), with a language switcher that preserves the current page.
- All UI text, navigation, and marketing copy translated and centralised in typed dictionary files (one per language) to guarantee no page is left partially translated.
- Right-to-left CSS support (mirrored spacing, borders, forced left-to-right for e-mail/phone fields) implemented for the Arabic version.
- Sitemap generated with correct hreflang alternate tags across all 3 languages (60 URLs total).

5.2 — WordPress integration for Solutions & Sectors

- The 5 Solutions and 4 Sectors pages (previously only "Fleet Management" existed in WordPress) were fully populated in WordPress and are editable by the team today.
- "Site Settings" content type (single WordPress entry) makes the homepage hero text, footer blurb, and contact details editable without code.
- Every WordPress-backed page automatically falls back to safe built-in content if WordPress is offline or a field is left empty — the production site can never show a blank page because of a WordPress outage.

5.3 — Legal & compliance pages

- Legal notice (mentions légales) page completed with the verified company registration (CarrierWeb Maroc, SARL AU, capital 194,900 MAD, registered April 2025).
- Privacy policy updated with a dedicated Moroccan data-protection (CNDP, law 09-08) section covering access, rectification and objection rights.

5.4 — SEO & content

- 3 in-depth resource articles written from scratch (fuel cost reduction, cold-chain compliance for ONSSA/EU export, TMS/GPS system integration) with full JSON-LD structured data for search engines.
- Google Search Console verification wired up via an environment variable, ready to activate once the verification code is available.

6. Quality Assurance

Every change delivered in this session was verified through multiple independent checks before being reported as complete:

- **Full production build** (`npm run build`) completed with zero errors — 73 static/dynamic pages generated successfully.
- **Type checking** (`tsc --noEmit`) — zero errors across the entire codebase.
- **Linting** (`eslint`) — zero errors and zero warnings across the entire codebase.
- **Live browser verification** — video playback, translated homepage sections (FR/EN/AR), and the contact form's fallback behaviour were all tested against a running instance of the site, not just inspected in source code.
- **Live WordPress verification** — after starting the WordPress instance, a direct GraphQL query confirmed the new Testimonials and Articles content types were correctly created and auto-populated, and that the public website successfully reads from them.
- **Dead-code audit** — every new file, function, and translation key added in this session was individually confirmed to be referenced and used elsewhere in the codebase; one leftover temporary diagnostic script (used only to debug a WordPress timing issue, see below) was identified and removed.

Issue found and fixed during QA

While verifying the WordPress auto-setup, the initial implementation was found to never actually run its one-time content pre-fill, because it was attached to a WordPress event that fires before post creation is fully available. This was diagnosed, corrected (moved to the appropriate later-firing event, with a self-healing check so it can never run twice), and re-verified as working before being reported complete.

7. Remaining Items — Client Action Needed

The following items are not code or engineering tasks — they require information or a decision from the CarrierWeb Maroc team before they can be finalised.

7.1 — SMTP mailbox credentials

The contact form works today via the `mailto:` fallback, but real server-side e-mail delivery needs a mailbox to send from. Provide (or approve using) a Gmail account, enable 2-step verification, generate an "app password", and add it to `.env.local` as documented in `.env.local.example`. Takes about 5 minutes.

7.2 — Legal registration numbers

The legal notice page has placeholders for the Commercial Registry (RC) number, the ICE number, and the tax identifier (IF) — all issued by Moroccan authorities at company registration. Needed before the page can be considered final for production.

7.3 — Publication director & hosting provider

The legal notice also needs the name/role of the person legally responsible for the site's content, and the name and address of the production hosting provider — the latter depends on where the site will ultimately be hosted (not yet decided).

7.4 — CNDP declaration receipt number

Morocco's data-protection authority (CNDP) requires a prior declaration for sites collecting personal data. The privacy policy already includes the required legal language and is marked "noindex" until this number is available, to avoid a non-compliant page being indexed by search engines.

7.5 — Google Search Console verification code

Search Console account setup and sitemap submission are ready to go — only the verification code from Google needs to be generated and added as an environment variable.

7.6 — Extending WordPress-editable content to other pages

This session covered Testimonials and Articles specifically, as requested. Other pages ("Why CarrierWeb", "Client Area", etc.) still use developer-maintained text, consistent with how navigation and marketing copy are handled across the trilingual site. This can be extended incrementally, page by page, on request.

End of report. For questions about any item above, or to prioritise the remaining work, reply in the project conversation.